

GOOGLE'S NEW PRIVACY POLICY EXPLAINED

Google announced that it was overhauling more than 60 of its privacy policies and replacing them with one single umbrella policy that will cover all its services. Danny Sullivan, Executive Editor of Search Engine Land explains the policy in detail, how it affects us as end-users and its ramifications in the time to come <http://goo.gl/kk91b>

WE WANT IPAD3

With rumours running rampant about Apple's forthcoming iPad 3 launch, many consumers are planning to buy one of the coveted tablets, including those who already own a Kindle Fire. These are results from a new survey carried out by TechBargains.com. Here's an infographic <http://goo.gl/Z9CdK>

UBUNTU FOR ANDROID

Cramming a desktop environment onto a smartphone is a fun project that promises very little actual usefulness. Ubuntu for Android takes a different approach and shows the OS as and when necessary like, when connected via USB to the system it gives you a full Unity desktop to play around with and a 10-foot Ubuntu TV interface when connected to a TV <http://goo.gl/F6Z2s>

INSIDE FOXCONN



Following weeks of intense scrutiny of worker treatment at Apple's Chinese suppliers, the tech giant granted ABC's Nightline unprecedented access to Foxconn's factories <http://goo.gl/dmlrC>



have noted that the [power] consumption is 40 percent less for DDR4 than for an equivalent DDR3 chip." Not bad. Another nugget of useful information on the site is the mention that DDR4 might make use of "pseudo open drain" technology, which was adapted from GDDR memory.

More interesting still is that you'll be able to finally forget about dual-, triple-, and quad-channel memory configurations. DDR4 will use a point-to-point topology, so there will be only one DIMM per channel. As Bit-tech pointed out, this is a continuation of the simplification process that memory has undergone ever since the move to DDR. As what happened when the PCI bus became PCI Express, "DDR4 will become a point-to-point bus and the parallelism is being left with the memory controller itself with multiple memory channels," the site explains.

I contacted Corsair, a company that knows just a little about memory, to find out what all this is likely to mean for system building. Robert Pearce, the company's senior technical marketing specialist, gave me some good information.

The first DDR4 chips, he told me, will be coming out at the end of 2012 — but "the initial target platforms are servers, not desktops." In fact, Pearce even acknowledged the rumors that DDR4 might never be seen on desktops at all, but went on to point out that "this is really something that will be dictated by Intel and AMD since they are the driving force behind the memory used in client computing platforms (based on the fact that the memory controller is integrated into the CPU)."

X-bit labs estimates that, if DDR4 does show up on desktops, it will probably be in 2014 and production ramp-up will be rapid, with DDR4 instantly garnering about 12% market share and increase to 56% in 2015. Given how long DDR3 took to catch on, I'm a bit skeptical about that, but it's far too early to say for sure.

Something else that's difficult to predict with any accuracy is what performance improvements users can

expect compared with DDR3 — and on that matter Pearce is rather conservative. "[They] are not likely to be very significant," he told me. "Over time, the DDR4 signaling structure will allow for higher bus frequencies, but the overall access times (clock period x latency) are not changing dramatically. This means that while there is higher peak bandwidth (which can provide performance improvements in a server environment where multiple accesses from completely independent threads can be queued up), the time needed to get data for a given request will not really change."

Sure, what will happen with DDR4 remains to be seen, but put me in the "optimistic" column. I recall people saying a lot of similar things about DDR3, too, a few years ago, and that eventually earned wide-scale adoption. Even if DDR4 changes on most fronts are minor, I think the industry will come around. Does it have any other choice?

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